of Western Command was reassigned to the Central Sector so that each of its three Brigades could be the *ab initio* reserve for one sub-sector each. If the Sector was to remain dormant, this Division was available to Central Command, thus giving them some offensive capability, which they were devoid of earlier. Additionally, all three sub-sectors were put under Central Command, thus freeing up Western Command to look Westwards only. 1 Corps, part of South Western Command was divested of its Armoured Division and de facto converted into another Mountain Strike Corps for the Northern and Central Sectors but under the operational control of Northern Command. 17 Corps, which only had 59 Infantry Division on its Order of Battle (ORBAT) was allotted 23 Infantry Division of 12 Corps. These changes meant that there were now five additional Divisions earmarked for the Northern Front. Overall, we now had 8 x Corps (57 per cent) looking to the West and 6 x Corps equivalent (43 per cent) looking Northwards, a much more balanced disposition.

Needless to say, the other Commands were not too happy with this reduction in their combat potential. The worst affected was South Western Command, which had also seen some decrements in the wake of the Doklam crisis. Some individual armoured and artillery units that had been inducted into Eastern Ladakh from Western, South Western and Southern Commands were permanently reassigned and put on the ORBAT of 14 Corps/Northern Command. Notable among these was the induction of K-9 Vajra, self-propelled guns into Eastern Ladakh. Five Regiments of K-9 Vajra had been acquired to provide fire support to armoured columns due to their matching mobility for deployment in the plains/desert areas. Moving these to the mountains was an out-of-the-box idea. Initially, only a battery of six guns was sent on

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